Jan Markmann

Hands-on Tech Lead / Engineering Manager

Hands-on Tech Lead and Engineering Manager with a strong backend and platform focus on PHP/Symfony, platform engineering, DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, and production systems. Combines software architecture and implementation depth with engineering management, people management, operational ownership, and cross-functional delivery. Makes technical decisions with reliability, maintainability, security, and business value in mind and works AI-first with coding agents, OpenAI Codex, Claude Code, OpenCode, and LLM-assisted workflows.

Experience

chargecloud GmbH

Jul 2022 - Present
3 yrs 9 mos

Tech Lead Roaming

Nov 2025 - Present
5 mos

Cologne (remote)

AI-first Tech Lead for OCPI and interface topics in a Kotlin/PHP stack, combining hands-on backend work with technical leadership across integration, operations, and business requirements in the roaming domain.

- Owned OCPI and interface topics in the roaming domain and aligned technical decisions across Product, Ops, and Engineering.
- Implemented OCPI in a mixed Kotlin/PHP stack and translated backend, integration, and operational requirements into a maintainable production-ready solution.
- Drove technical documentation for interfaces and operational requirements to reduce coordination overhead and enable more reliable delivery.
- Integrated coding agents and LLM-assisted workflows into day-to-day engineering to speed up implementation, technical documentation, and research.
- Tech: Kotlin, PHP 8, Symfony, Docker, Helm, Kafka, MariaDB, OpenAI Codex, Claude Code, OpenCode

Team Lead IT / SysOps / DevOps

Dec 2023 - Oct 2025
1 yr 11 mos

Cologne (remote)

Led DevOps, IT, and SysOps with both technical and line management responsibility and owned the platform's operational and delivery maturity. The role combined people leadership with hands-on platform engineering across CI/CD, container and Kubernetes operations, incident management, external providers, and security-related operational topics.

- Led a DevOps, IT, and SysOps team of up to 8 with technical and line management responsibility, including coaching, prioritization, hiring support, and stakeholder management.
- Built and evolved CI/CD and deployment standards with GitLab and TeamCity to make releases more reproducible and platform operations more reliable.
- Established incident management and operational routines for SLA-relevant systems to shorten the path from alert to coordinated response.

- Moved deployments to Docker and introduced Ansible-based infrastructure and operational workflows to improve delivery consistency and operational maturity.
- Owned security-related operational and policy topics, managed external providers, and structured collaboration across operations, IT, and security.
- Tech: PHP 8, Symfony, Caddy, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes, GitLab, Renovate, TeamCity, Ansible, Harbor, Linux, Backstage

Senior Software Engineer & People Lead

Jul 2022 - Nov 2023
1 yr 5 mos

Cologne (remote)

Combined hands-on backend and platform engineering with first formal People Lead responsibility. Alongside implementation work, the role focused on technical ownership, delivery, operability, and the development of individual team members.

- Led backend and platform topics in a PHP/Symfony environment and took technical ownership for delivery within the team.
- Supported individual team members as People Lead through 1:1s, feedback, development conversations, and day-to-day guidance.
- Built, migrated, and operated Docker stacks and Kubernetes/Helm setups while documenting the target architecture for scalable platform operations.
- Bridged Product, Ops, and Engineering on delivery and operational topics and helped structure implementation across teams.
- Tech: PHP 8, Symfony, Caddy, Docker, GitLab, TeamCity, Ansible, Linux

Senior Software Developer

Jan 2021 - Jun 2022
1 yr 5 mos

Digital Control GmbH & Co. KG

Dusseldorf (remote)

Developed and operated components in a Kubernetes-based microservice architecture focused on object storage, document generation, platform integration, and observability.

- Implemented a multi-tenant S3 storage solution as a reusable platform building block, including provisioning Kubernetes and MinIO resources from Symfony.
- Built a PDF generator for product data sheets within an e-commerce microservice architecture to support automated document delivery.
- Set up Grafana on top of Graylog data and exposed reliability metrics to improve operational transparency and earlier problem detection.

- Tech: PHP 7, Symfony, Docker, Google Cloud Run, Kubernetes, MinIO, Rancher, GitLab, InfluxDB, Grafana, Graylog

Software Developer, Consultant & Interim Head of IT

Mar 2020 - Jan 2021

9 mos

Self-employed

Cologne

Served as interim head of IT and consultant with a focus on IT/DevOps tooling, hiring support, delivery standards, and infrastructure consolidation. Also took over and stabilized Shopware 6 on AWS.

- Served as interim head of IT and helped shape hiring for SysOps and development roles.
- Built a reliable development and DevOps foundation for a junior Shopware team, including Docker, GitLab CI, and review apps.
- Built and integrated REST and GraphQL APIs, including MongoDB-backed integrations.
- Took over, consolidated, and operated Shopware 6 hosting on AWS (EC2) to stabilize day-to-day operations.
- Consolidated and standardized local and external IT infrastructure to reduce operational complexity and improve maintainability.
- Tech: PHP 7, Shopware, Symfony, AWS, Caddy, Docker, GitLab/GitHub, MongoDB, Linux

Senior Software Developer

May 2019 - Mar 2020

10 mos

Graph-IT GmbH

Cologne

Worked on an internal graph-based database system with a focus on data and process modeling. Also delivered industrial automation prototypes with Raspberry Pi and Python.

- Enhanced the internal graph database system across backend and domain model layers.
- Built and maintained GraphQL APIs and integrations for internal platform use cases.
- Modeled data structures and process flows within the graph-based system to support business-specific workflows.
- Developed industrial automation prototypes with Raspberry Pi and async Python, including fieldbus integration via Modbus/RS-485.
- Tech: GraphQL, PHP7, Python (async), Symfony, GitLab, Modbus/RS-485

Software Developer & Consultant

May 2017 - Apr 2019

1 yr 11 mos

Self-employed

Cologne

Freelance work in agency and enterprise environments, including e-commerce and DevOps. Focus: Symfony/PHP, integrations, and service-oriented architectures.

- Introduced or improved DevOps tooling and CI/CD workflows in project teams to strengthen delivery reliability.
- Stabilized delivery and quality in an enterprise client project team within an agency setup.
- Enhanced internal applications for sales and process control in line with business needs.
- Implemented and adapted Spryker-based e-commerce requirements in a service-oriented environment.
- Built REST APIs to connect satellite projects, including ERP data export integrations.
- Tech: Doctrine, PHP7, PHPUnit, Spryker, Symfony 3.x, GitLab, MySQL, PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, Propel

Team Lead Software Engineering

Oct 2013 - Apr 2017

3 yrs 6 mos

preis24.de GmbH

Dusseldorf

Led software engineering: maintained a legacy platform and designed and built a new service-oriented sales platform. Introduced agile practices and strengthened QA, CI, and DevOps standards, combining technical direction with hands-on execution.

- Technical and disciplinary leadership of the software engineering team, with responsibility for technical priorities and delivery.
- Introduced and evolved agile practices (Kanban, Scrum) and embedded them in the team.
- Kept the legacy platform stable and moving while preparing the transition to a new target architecture.
- Designed and built a new service-oriented sales platform as the technical replacement path out of the legacy system.
- Tech: Doctrine, PHP5, PHPUnit, REST/SOAP, Symfony2, GitHub, Travis CI, MongoDB, MySQL5, Redis, Jira, Zend Framework

Software Developer

Jul 2010 - Sep 2013

3 yrs 2 mos

Questback

Cologne

Maintained and extended an enterprise feedback suite and developed new components. Also built a social media monitoring application.

- Developed new product components and modules within the Enterprise Feedback Suite.
- Built a social media monitoring application including API integrations.
- Implemented JSON-RPC and SOAP web services and integrated them into the existing system landscape.
- Maintained and extended the Enterprise Feedback Suite.
- Tech: PHP5, Symfony Components, Hudson/Jenkins, Social Media APIs, MySQL5, Assetic, Zend Framework

Software Developer and Consultant

Oct 2009 - Jul 2010

8 mos

Self-employed

Freelance project work as software developer and consultant focused on PHP/MySQL and symfony 1.3–1.4.

- Project work as software developer and consultant.
- Tech: Java, PHP5, symfony 1.3–1.4, MySQL, Eclipse/OSGI, ezComponents, Linux, Smarty, Typo3, UML

Senior Software Developer / Team Lead

Oct 2008 - Oct 2009

1 yr

silversurfer7 GmbH

Cologne

Senior engineering and team leadership in an agency environment, focusing on portal and platform development in cross-functional teams.

- Team and development lead in agency web projects.
- Built portals for the tourism industry.
- Built a product catalog for providers of security and surveillance technology.
- Tech: PHP5, Symfony, MySQL5, Internet-Booking-Engines, Propel, Zend Lucene Search

Software Developer

Feb 2008 - Oct 2008

8 mos

best webnews GmbH

Cologne

Worked on a news aggregation portal, enriching content with metadata (including geographic data) and delivering partner integrations.

- Built and enhanced a news portal for aggregation and presentation.
- Implemented metadata enrichment (notably geographic) and partner embedding.
- Tech: CakePHP, PHP5, MySQL5, AJAX, Drupal, jQuery, Netvibes UWA

PHP Programmer

Jan 2006 - Jan 2008

2 yrs

Agentur Grintsch e.K.

Cologne

Software development for enterprise and mid-sized clients, including Epson Germany.

- Software development for enterprise and mid-sized clients, including Epson Germany.
- Built a printer leasing system.
- Built and maintained a product database.
- Tech: PHP5, Symfony, MySQL5, Propel, Zend Lucene Search

Education

Cologne University of Applied Sciences (Campus Gummersbach)

Dec 2003 - Dec 2005

Business Information Systems studies (no degree completed) in Business Information Systems

Oberberg Vocational College, Gummersbach

Dec 2000 - Dec 2003

State-certified IT Assistant, advanced technical college entrance qualification in Information Technology

Skills

Engineering Leadership

- Technical leadership
- Engineering management
- People management
- Line management
- Mentoring
- Stakeholder management
- Cross-functional alignment

Backend Engineering

- PHP 8.x
- Symfony
- API Platform
- REST
- Backend development
- Software architecture

Platform & Cloud

- Platform engineering
- DevOps
- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Helm
- AWS
- GitLab CI
- Ansible
- Infrastructure as Code

Architecture & Delivery

- Service-oriented architecture
- DDD
- Migration strategies
- CI/CD
- Release engineering
- Technical decision-making
- Software delivery

Integrations & Messaging

- GraphQL
- OpenAPI
- Kafka
- RabbitMQ
- OCPI

Quality & Reliability

- Automated testing
- PHPUnit
- Static analysis
- Test-Driven Development
- Incident management
- Observability
- Production operations

Security & Compliance

- ISO 27001
- ISMS
- Incident response
- Vulnerability management

Data Platforms

- MySQL
- MariaDB
- PostgreSQL
- MongoDB
- Redis

Collaboration & Ways of Working

AI & AI-first Engineering

Scrum
Kanban
Jira
Slack
Confluence

AI-first Development
OpenAI Codex / Claude Code / OpenCode
LLM-assisted code generation
Prompt engineering
AI-assisted development workflows
Tooling around coding agents
Agentic workflows

Languages

German — Native
English — Fluent

Interests

Mountain biking

Trails, Dirt, Slopestyle

Music

Piano, Harmonica, Blues, Boogie Woogie

Smart Home

Home automation, Open systems, DIY electronics

Artificial Intelligence

LLMs in software development, Personal AI assistants and agent tooling, Agentic workflows

Baking